then tortured to death? And if so, under whose instructions? Was anyone of the members of the 1 Akbar Road group in touch with senior army officers involved in that operation, directly or indirectly? And if so, for what purpose? Did the Golden Temple library catch fire accidentally or it was a case of arson? Were some precious historical books/documents and artefacts seized by the army from the library? If so, can they be returned? How many persons died in encounters with police in Punjab till the mid-1990s and how many of those encounters were real, and how many false? How many people are still missing in Punjab and not accounted for so far?

Regarding the murders, rapes, looting and burning of Sikh properties in Delhi and other cities in India in November 1984, the first thing that needs to be decided is whether what happened was a simple riot or needs to be classified as a pogrom or even a genocide, as per Article 2 of the UN Convention on Genocide, with its related consequences for the perpetrators of such heinous crimes. Was it pre-planned? Were the controlling powers of the home minister over Delhi Police usurped by the 1 Akbar Road group?

Who were the powerful persons who planned and directed what happened during the four fateful nights and days in Delhi from 31 October to 3 November 1984? How many people actually died in Delhi and elsewhere? What was the role of the Delhi police, especially some of the officers, first in overlooking or encouraging the killers and then later in covering up the culpability of those involved? Who were the persons behind the cover-ups? Why has justice not been dispensed to the aggrieved parties for such a long time?

These are some points that I could think of as the scope for a truth and reconciliation commission. I am sure there are better informed and more knowledgeable people who could add to this list of questions. Some of the terms of the South African TRC could also be incorporated in India's TRC. Besides, the TRC could be given the mandate to form its own questions as the inquiry progresses. The general amnesty clause could encourage a number of people to reveal important information. Two or more 'reconciliation registers' could be established, so that Indians who